



WEEK 4 | MEDIA, GENDER AND CRITICAL THINKING

媒體素養、性別與批判性思維

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Learning Goals

01. Recognize how gender norms and power operate in viral events and media narratives.
認識到性別規範和權力如何在網路熱點事件和媒體敘事中發揮作用
02. Apply a four-step critical thinking framework (Describe → Analyze → Build Vision → Develop Action).
運用四步驟批判性思考架構（描述 → 分析 → 建構願景 → 制定行動）
03. Move from individual reaction to structural understanding of gender regulation in society.
從個人反應出發，深入理解社會中性別規制的結構性議題

Theoretical Foundation: Gender, Power, and Social Regulation

From Individual Expression to Social Structure

In previous weeks we explored:

- Gender as social construction
- Naming as expectation
- Gender expression as presentation

Today we shift:

From identity 認同 → to regulation 規制

From expression 表達 → to enforcement 強制執行

From reaction 反應 → to structure 結構



Theoretical Foundation: Gender, Power, and Social Regulation

From Individual Expression to Social Structure

From a social construction perspective, gender norms are maintained through:

- repetition
- approval
- ridicule
- correction
- silence
- media amplification



Theoretical Foundation: Gender, Power, and Social Regulation

From Individual Expression to Social Structure

What is considered “normal” masculinity or femininity is socially reinforced – not biologically fixed.

被認為是「正常」的男性氣質或女性氣質是社會強化的結果，而非生物學上固定不變的。



Deepening the Theoretical Lens

Gender Policing性別監管

The informal and formal mechanisms through which society corrects those who deviate 偏離 from expected gender norms.

Respectability Politics體面政治

The idea that certain gender expressions are considered “acceptable” or “appropriate 恰當” in order to deserve respect or safety.

Moral Panic道德恐慌

A social reaction in which perceived deviation from norms triggers exaggerated 過度 fear, outrage 憤怒, or public anxiety.

Deepening the Theoretical Lens

Gender is not only personal identity.

Gender is socially organized power.

Today's focus:

How gender norms are enforced 性別規範如何被強化

How media amplifies 放大 enforcement 強化作用

How viral discourse 病毒式傳播 becomes regulatory power

Critical Thinking Framework

We will use a four-step analytical model:

1. Describe描述 – What is happening?
2. Analyze分析 – What norms and power relations are operating?
3. Build Vision建構願景 – What would fairness or equity look like?
4. Develop Action制定行動 – What structural or social changes are possible?



Icebreaker Case: Metro Priority Seat Incident

In a Taipei MRT carriage, an elderly woman repeatedly kicks the knee of a young passenger wearing long hair and a skirt.

The kicking happens once. Then again. Then again.

The young passenger responds calmly in English: "You can one more try."

The elderly woman appears shocked and says: "太可怕了，這個不是女生。" ("This is not a girl.")

The clip goes viral. Online comments focus less on violence and more on gender confusion.

Icebreaker Case: Metro Priority Seat Incident

Public debate erupts about:

- Priority seating優先座位
- Gender appearance性別外在表現
- Masculinity男性氣質
- Safety安全
- Social anxiety社交焦慮

[Metro incident link – insert here]

Icebreaker Case: Metro Priority Seat Incident

Now observe media framing:

Did headlines focus on violence?

Or gender ambiguity?

This is where gender policing occurs.

Misrecognition誤認 → correction糾正 → public amplification公眾放大 → hierarchy reinforcement等級制度強化.

Media did not merely report the event.

It curated emotional focus.

This is gender regulation through virality.

Icebreaker Case: Metro Priority Seat Incident

Final structural question:

What exactly was being policed here — behavior, violence, or gender?



Four-Step Critical Thinking Practice

Apply to the Metro Case.

You have 20 minutes to discuss using this map.

Each step helps you think deeper.

Please write keywords or sketch your ideas.



Four-Step Critical Thinking Practice

Step 1 – Describe

No evaluation.

Only observable facts.



Four-Step Critical Thinking Practice

Step 2 – Analyze

- What stereotype刻板印象 was operating?
- What gender norm was violated違反?
- Who held symbolic authority象徵性權威?
- Was there moral panic道德恐慌?
- How did social media amplify放大 reaction?



Four-Step Critical Thinking Practice

Step 3 – Build a Vision

If gender literacy 性別素養 were higher:

- How would headlines change?
- How would comments differ?
- How would bystanders 旁觀者 respond?



Four-Step Critical Thinking Practice

Step 4 – Develop Action

- Media literacy education 媒體素養教育
- Platform moderation 平台審核
- Personal comment responsibility 個人評論責任
- Policy-level interventions 政策層面干預



Scripted Narrative: Fated to Love You (命中註定我愛你)

Before Watching – Analytical Lens

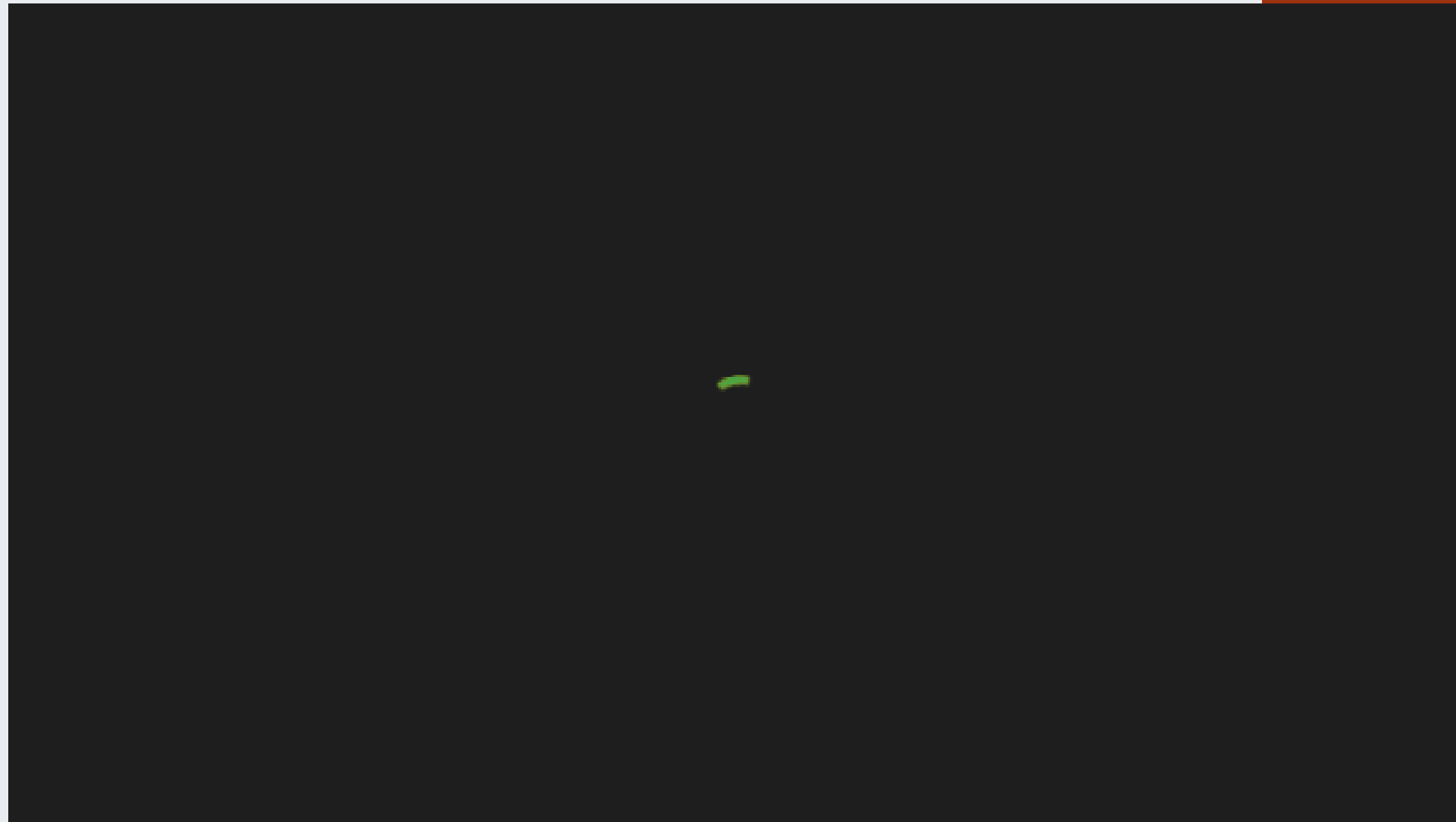
Observe:

- Who initiates 主導 control?
- Who apologizes more?
- Who sacrifices 犧牲?
- Is persistence 堅持 romanticized?
- Are boundaries aestheticized 被美化?
- Does destiny justify imbalance? 命運是否能為失衡開脫？

(命中註定我愛你)

[影片片段連結：請補上]

Videos



Scripted Narrative: Fated to Love You (命中註定我愛你)

After Viewing – Guided Structural Discussion

Common romantic drama patterns:

Male emotional dominance normalized 男性情感主導地位正常化

Female endurance framed as virtue 女性的忍耐被視為美德

Jealousy romanticized 嫉妒被浪漫化

Persistence rewarded 堅持不懈終獲回報



Scripted Narrative: Fated to Love You (命中註定我愛你)

After Viewing – Guided Structural Discussion

Do you see any moments that challenge stereotypes?
Are there alternative readings?



泰國搞笑香水廣告 –
白雪公主講道理，不管劇情做自己

Videos

Advertisement Analysis – Group Task

Group Requirements

Each group must:

1. Play 30–60 seconds
2. Describe visible narrative
3. Identify one visible stereotype
4. Identify one hidden structural assumption
5. Rewrite a more equitable version
6. Propose one real-life action strategy



Advertisement Analysis – Group Task

Mini Oral Report Template

1. In this clip, we see... (Describe)
2. A stereotype we noticed is... (Analyze)
3. This reflects gender policing / respectability politics because...
(Theory link)
4. Our vision is... (Build Vision)
5. One action strategy is... (Develop Action)



Advertisement Analysis – Group Task

Advanced Prompts

1. Is empowerment authentic or commodified? 賦權是真誠的還是商品化的？
2. Does rebellion become marketable? 反抗是否變得有利可圖？
3. Who profits from this narrative? 誰從這種敘述中獲利？
4. Is diversity structural or aesthetic? 多樣性是結構性的還是美學性的？

Teacher Synthesis

Same mechanism:

Representation呈現 → Reaction反應 → Reinforcement強化

Media does not merely reflect society.

It organizes interpretation.

It rewards conformity.

It punishes deviation.

It defines normalcy.



ESP Interactive Kahoot Recap



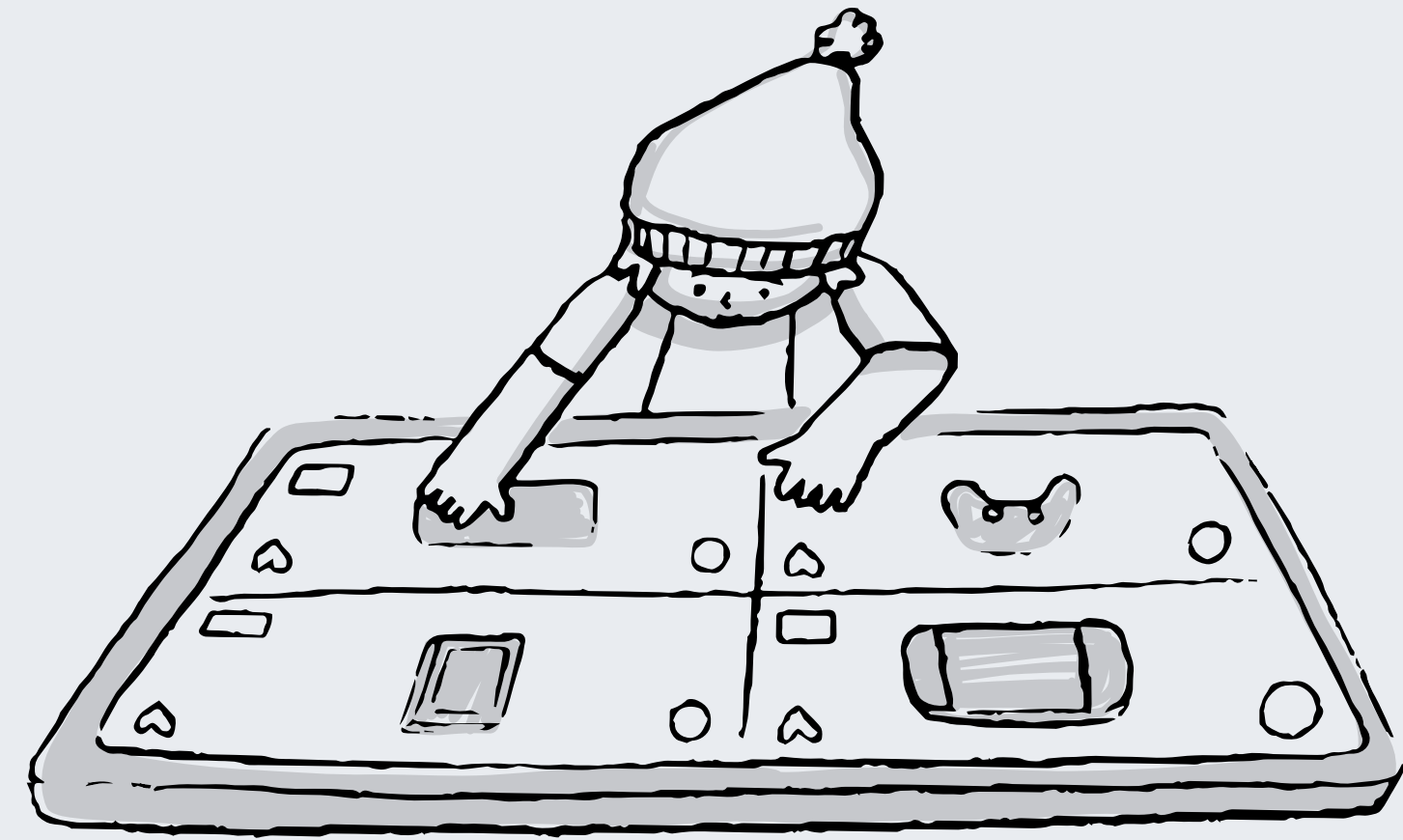
[Kahoot link: insert here]



Homework

Submit:

- Clip link + timestamp
- 4-step analysis diagram
- 6–8 sentence structured mini-report using sentence starters



Week 4

MEDIA LITERACY, GENDER, AND CRITICAL THINKING

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